to widespread poverty among the masses. They also refer to the prevalence of slavery.

The state had to derive their revenue only by taxing the people. It is found that during the Sangama dynasty when the Vijayanagar rule was extended to new areas, their officers were harsh in tax collection, which provoked the toiling people to rise in revolt. One such revolt took place in 1430 in central parts of Tamil Nadu. This was the revolt in which all the basic producers joined forgetting their caste differences. The revolt took place due to the unjust and arbitrary tax demands of the government including the *pradhani* (governor), his military bodies, and the landlords. It is said the Vijayanagar Prince intervened and pacified the revolting people by allowing tax reduction. During the sixteenth century, under the Nayak system, the local Nayakas tried to encourage craft production, like weaving, by giving tax concessions now and then.

The Vijayanagar period witnessed striking development in the field of non-agrarian crafts. Until the thirteenth century the economy was mainly agrarian. From the fourteenth onwards the economy became more commercial. With the beginning of the era of money economy, circulation and use of coined money increased manifold. Artisans like weavers, smiths, and masons became more prominent in the society. These non-agrarian groups were generally called the *pattadai* (workshop people) or *kasaya-vargam* -that is- the group that pays taxes in cash. Large number of commercial and weaving centres came up in northern Tamil Nadu, Rayalasima and coastal Andhra. Naturally the textiles formed an important commodity exported from south Indian ports. Textiles became main commercial attractions for the Portuguese and other European traders who started coming from the early sixteenth century.

## 12.5 Literature

The Vijayanagara rulers were also great patrons of literature. The rulers encouraged Sanskrit, Tamil, Telugu and Kannada literatures and languages. The literary development reached its peak during the reign of Krishnadeva Raya. He was also a great patron of art and literature, and was known as 'Andhra Bhoja'.

Sayana, the great Sanskrit scholar of this period, wrote commentaries on the Vedas. These commentaries are considered as standard commentaries even today. He was a minister of Harihara II. Madhavacharya was a well-known Sanskrit scholar who was intimately connected with Vijayanagar royal family. Gangadevi, wife of Kampana, son of Bukka, deserves a pre-eminent place among the writers of the age. In her famous work Maduravijayam, she describes in mahakavya style the conquest of Madura by her husband. Hannamma and Thirumalamma were famous poets of this period. Hannamma was a reporter in the court of Deveraya II.

Krishnadeva Raya patronized Tamil scholars. Tamil Scholars of Saivism, Vaishnavism and Jainism were encouraged. Tirumalainatha and his son Paranjyothiyar were well known scholars of the period. Chidambara Puranam and Chokkanatharula were written by Tirumalainatha. Sevvaichchbuduvar translated the Bhagavata Puranam into Tamil. Vadamalavi Annagalayyam was the author of Irusamaya Filakkain, a work on Vaishnavism.

Nachana Somanatha was a great scholar both in Sanskrit and Telugu. The greatest poet during the era was, however, Pillalamarri Pina Virabhadra Kavi who composed the Telugu version of Kalidasa's Shakuntalam in verse. Devaraya I was a great patron of learning. In his court lived the famous Telugu poet Srinatha who wrote Haravilasam.

Krishnadeva Raya was known as Abhinava Bhoja. Eight great Telugu poets adorned his court. They were known as Ashtadiggajas. Allasani Peddanna, Nandi Thimmanna, Tenali Rama and others were the Telugu poets in his court. Allasani Peddanna was the greatest and he was often described as 'Andhrakavita-Pitamaha'. Allasani Peddanna was the author of Manucharita in Telugu. Tenali Rama was the most famous scholar and jester of Krishnadeva



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